Hyunjoo Yang

School of Economics
Sogang University
Mapo-gu Baekbeom-ro 35
Seoul, South Korea 04107

Email: hyang@sogang.ac.kr
Homepage: hy263.github.io

Last updated: October 10, 2026

Research

Development and growth issues of South Korea

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, Brown University 2016.

M.Sc. in Economics, London School of Economics 2010.

B.A. in Trade and Commerce, Incheon National University 2008.

Appointments

Aug. 2025 - present: Deputy Center Director, Research Center for Big Data on Korean Economy, Sogang University

Sep. 2021 - present: Associate professor, College of Economics, Sogang University

Jan. 2022 - present: Affiliated faculty, Graduate School of Artificial Intelligence, Sogang University

Sep. 2023 - Aug. 2024: Visiting scholar, Department of Economics, Brown University

Sep. 2023: Visiting scholar, Cowles Foundation, Yale University

Mar. 2020 - Aug. 2021: Assistant professor, College of Economics, Sogang University

Mar. 2019 - Aug. 2023: Visiting professor, Data Science Group, Institute for Basic Science

Sep. 2017 - Feb. 2020: Assistant professor, School of Northeast Asian Studies, Incheon National University, South Korea

Sep. 2016 - Aug. 2017: Associate fellow, Korea Development Institute, South Korea

May 2013 - July 2013: Short-term consultant, World Bank

June 2009 - Aug. 2009: Research scholar, International Crops Research Institute for the Semi-Arid Tropics, India

Working Papers

Neighbors After the Purge: Killings, Lineage, and Cooperation in Korean Villages, 1950–1972, SSRN Working Paper 7534558
Hyunjoo Yang
(previously circulated as "The Effect of War on Local Collective Action: Evidence from the Korean War", SSRN Working Paper 3162661)

Zoning by Fire: State Violence and the Long-Run Geography of Jeju, 1948–2019
Hyunjoo Yang *and Kyeongsoon Moon*

Deworming, Reinfection, and Village Conditions: Evidence from Korean Primary Schools, 1971–1977
Jungho Kim and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

The Geography of Fertility: Theory and Evidence from Korea
Costas Arkolakis, Jun Hee Kwak, ***Hyunjoo Yang****, and Jaemin Woo*

Shadow of Authoritarian Patronage: Village Leaders and Elections in Democratizing South Korea
Ji Yeon Hong, Sunkyoung Park, and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Gambling for Goals
Costas Arkolakis, Spencer Y. Kwon, Dominic Russel, Claire Shi, and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Using Maps to Predict Economic Activity
Imryoung Jeong and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Land Reform, Entrepreneurship, and Economic Growth in South Korea
Jongryong Park and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Teaching Machines to Measure Economic Activities from Satellite Images: Challenges and Solutions
Sungwon Han, Donghyun Ahn, Sungwon Park, Jeasurk Yang, Susang Lee, Jihee Kim, ***Hyunjoo Yang****, Sangyoon Park, and Meeyoung Cha*

Did High-Speed Trains Promote Local Economic Activities? Evidence from the Introduction of Korea Train Express
Elliot Kang, Kanghyock Koh, and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Village Leadership and Rural Development in South Korea
Sunjin Kim, Taejong Kim, and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Publications - Economics: Korean History

Land Reform at the Parcel Level: A Spatial Reconstruction from a Korean Village, 1915–2023, **2026**, **International Journal of Empirical Economics**, (Forthcoming)
Jongryong Park and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Inside the Reform: Patterns of Ex-Ante Disposals of Farmland in Anryong-myeon, Suwon, as Seen Through the Jise Myeonggijang, **2026**, **Korean Culture**, 114, 289–318, (In Korean)
Jongryong Park and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Measuring Historical Settlement and Agricultural Structure from Topographic Maps: An Object Detection Approach for South Korea, 1918 and 1970, **2026**, **Kyungje Sahak: Review of Economic History**, 50(2), 99–138
Hyunjoo Yang, *Izzat Hassan Bin Halim, and Jeongeun Kim*

The Effects of South Korean Protestantism on Human Capital and Female Empowerment, 1930–2010, **2023**, **Journal of Comparative Economics**, 51(2), 422–438
Yutaro Izumi, Sangyoon Park, and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Family Clans and Public Goods: Evidence from the New Village Beautification Project in South Korea, **2019**, **Journal of Development Economics**, 136, 34–50
Hyunjoo Yang
- 2019 Korean Economy Academic Research Award, Korean Economic Association

Publications - Economics: Current Korean Issues

To Move or Not to Move? Immigration and Natives' Neighborhood Choices in Seoul, Korea, **2022**, **Journal of Economic Geography**, 22(4), 779–799
Joseph Han, Jinwook Hur, Jongkwan Lee, and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Social Insurance in an Aging Population: Impacts of a Government Transfer Program in South Korea, **2021**, **Economic Development and Cultural Change**, 69(4)
Kanghyock Koh and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

Is There Regional Inequality in Medical Accessibility of the Severely Injured? Application of Driving Time Data in South Korea, **2020**, **Journal of Market Economy**, 49(1), 1–29
Hyunjoo Yang, *Elliot Kang, Min Gyung Kim, and Kanghyock Koh*

Publications - Political Science

In Strongman We Trust: The Political Legacy of the New Village Movement in South Korea, **2023**, **American Journal of Political Science**, 67(4), 850–866
Ji Yeon Hong, Sunkyoung Park, and ***Hyunjoo Yang***

- 2023 Best Article Prize in the Study of Democracy & Autocracy, American Political Science Association

Publications - Multidisciplinary Sciences

A Human-Machine Collaborative Approach Measures Economic Development Using Satellite Imagery, **2023**, **Nature Communications**, 14, Article 6811
*Donghyun Ahn, Jeasurk Yang, Meeyoung Cha, **Hyunjoo Yang**, Jihee Kim, Sangyoon Park, Sungwon Han, Eunji Lee, Susang Lee, and Sungwon Park*

Disaster Assessment Using Computer Vision and Satellite Imagery: Applications in Detecting Water-Related Building Damages, **2022**, **Frontiers in Environmental Science**, 10, Article 969758
*Danu Kim, Jeongkyung Won, Eunji Lee, Kyung Ryul Park, Jihee Kim, Sangyoon Park, **Hyunjoo Yang**, and Meeyoung Cha*

Publications - Hospitality and Tourism

Effects of Visual Cues and Social Density on Beverage Consumption: A Field Experiment in a Bar, **2022**, **Cornell Hospitality Quarterly**, 63(2), 182–194
*Min Gyung Kim, **Hyunjoo Yang**, and Anna S. Mattila*

Persistent Effects of Mega-Events on Local Economies: An Application of Administrative Big Data, **2021**, **Asia Pacific Journal of Tourism Research**, 26(12)
*Min Gyung Kim and **Hyunjoo Yang***

The Impact of Customer Loyalty on Restaurant Sanitation Grades and the Importance of Narrative Information: The Case of New York Restaurant Sanitation Grading System, **2018**, **Cornell Hospitality Quarterly**, 59(3)
*Min Gyung Kim, **Hyunjoo Yang**, and Anna S. Mattila*

Computer Science Conference Proceedings

Fine-Grained Socioeconomic Prediction from Satellite Images with Distributional Adjustment, **2023**, **Proceedings of the 32nd ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management (CIKM '23)**, 3717–3721
*Donghyun Ahn, Minhyuk Song, Seungeon Lee, Yubin Choi, Jihee Kim, Sangyoon Park, **Hyunjoo Yang**, and Meeyoung Cha*

Learning Economic Indicators by Aggregating Multi-Level Geospatial Information, **2022**, **Proceedings of the AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI-22)**, 36(11), 12053–12061
*Sungwon Park, Sungwon Han, Donghyun Ahn, Jaeyeon Kim, Jeasurk Yang, Susang Lee, Seunghoon Hong, Jihee Kim, Sangyoon Park, **Hyunjoo Yang**, and Meeyoung Cha*

Learning to Score Economic Development from Satellite Imagery, **2020**, **Proceedings of the 26th ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (KDD '20)**, 2970–2979
Sungwon Han, Donghyun Ahn, Sungwon Park, Jeasurk Yang, Susang Lee, Jihee Kim, ***Hyunjoo Yang****, Sangyoon Park, and Meeyoung Cha*

Book

Saemaul Undong [The New Village Movement], **2026**, **Haenam**, (In Korean; Korean Economy Citizens' Lectures 25; ISBN 978-89-6238-825-1)
Hyunjoo Yang

Professional Activities

Associate Editor, *International Economic Journal* (2026–present); *KDI Journal of Economic Policy* (2026–present); *Korean Journal of Economic Studies*, Development field (2026–present)

Program Committee (Reviewer), AAAI-27 Special Track on AI for Social Impact (2026)

Chair of the graduate program, College of Economics, Sogang University (2022-2023, 2026-2027)

Recruiting Committee for tenure-track faculty, College of Economics, Sogang University (2021-2022)

Chair of Korea Trade and Commerce Major, School of Northeast Asian Studies, Incheon National University (2019-2020)

Commissioned Admission Officer, Incheon National University (2019-2020)

Hiring Committee for tenure and non-tenure track faculty, School of Northeast Asian Studies, Incheon National University (2019)

Admissions Committee, Korean Trade and Commerce Major, School of Northeast Asian Studies, Incheon National University (2018 – 2019)

Admissions Committee, Northeast Asia Trade and Commerce Major, School of Northeast Asian Studies, Incheon National University (2017 – 2019)

Referee for *American Journal of Political Science, European Journal of Development Research, Explorations in Economic History, International Economic Journal, International Journal of Empirical Economics, Journal of Comparative Economics, Journal of Cultural Economics, Journal of Development Effectiveness, Journal of Economic Development, Journal of Economic Growth, Journal of Economic Theory and Econometrics, Journal of Market Economy, Journal of Poverty Alleviation and International Development, Journal of Regional Science, Journal of Urban Economics, KDI Journal of Economic Policy, Korean Economic Forum, Korean Economic Review, Korean Journal of Public Finance, PLOS One, Oxford Bulletin of Economics and Statistics, Oxford Economic Papers, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics, Seoul Journal of Economics, World Development*

Conference and Seminar Presentations

2026: Hong Kong University of Science and Technology Workshop on the Quantitative History of East and Southeast Asia; KDI School; KER International Conference; Long-Term Perspectives on Economic Growth: Korea, Taiwan and Beyond; Park Chung Hee Academy Colloquium; Seoul National University Graduate School of International Studies; Yonsei University

2025: Ajou University, Asian Cliometrics Workshop, Incheon National University, Korean Economic Review (KER) International Conference, Seoul National University

2024: Brown University Economics Department Growth Breakfast, Florida State University Economics Department Applied Micro Seminar

2023: Brown University Economics Department Growth Breakfast; Chonnam National University; Harvard University International Conference on the Tools of the Trade: The Way Forward; Korea Advanced Institute of Science and Technology; Korea Institute for International Economic Policy; Korea Institute of Public Finance; Korea's Allied Economic Associations Annual Meeting; Soongsil University; Yale University Data Intensive Social Science Center Workshop

2022: Asia Meeting of Econometric Society; IBS Winter School on AI-Boosted Basic Science; ITC and International Development Forum; Kobe University Rokko Forum; Korea University CIS-GSIS Global Inaugural Seminar; Korea's Allied Economic Associations Annual Meeting (Korean Economic History Society session); MIT Center for Real Estate Workshop on Machine Learning and Social Science; Satellite Application Conference; Seoul National University H-Trio Seminar; SKKU Economics Department Seminar; SNU-UC San Diego Joint Webinar; The 10th Anniversary Conference of K-Developedia; The Korean Historical Association Conference

2021: KAEA Applied Micro Seminar; KAIST AI + X Forum, Meet the Data Scientists; Korea Foundation for Advanced Studies; Korea's Allied Economic Associations Annual Meeting; Korean Economic Association North Korean Economy Policy Forum; Kyunghee University Economics Department Seminar

2020: ASSA San Diego; Econometric Society World Congress; Hitotsubashi University IER; KER International Conference; Korea University Economics Department Seminar; Osaka University ISER; Seoul National University

2019: Hanyang University; History and Development Network Monthly Meeting; Institute for Basic Science; KDI School of Public Policy and Management; Korea Academic Society of Industrial Organization Monthly Meeting; Korea Aerospace Research Institute; Korea Economic History Society Meeting; Korea University Institute of Governmental Studies; Korea University Economics Department Seminar; Seoul National University Workshop on Experimental Economics and Development Economics; Sogang University; University of Seoul; University of Tokyo; Yonsei University

2018: Asian and Australasian Society of Labour Economics; Asian Development Bank Institute; Asian Historical Economics Conference; Asian Real Estate Society Annual Conference; Association of Korean Economic Studies International Confer-

ence; Hong Kong University of Science and Technology; International Symposium on Quantitative History; Korean Association of Public Finance Monthly seminar; Korean Economic Meetings of Macroeconomics; Korean Economic Association International Conference; National Graduate Institute for Policy Studies; Royal Economic Society Conference; University of Hong Kong

2017: Asian and Australasian Society of Labour Economics; Asian Meeting of the Econometric Society; Incheon National University; KDI School of Public Policy and Management; Korea Academic Society of Industrial Organization Fall Meeting; Korea Development Institute; Korea Economic History Society Meeting; Korea's Allied Economic Associations Annual Meeting; Korean Labor Economic Association Monthly Seminar; Korean Resource Economics Association Monthly Seminar; Pusan National University; Seoul National University Applied Micro Workshop; Sogang University; Western Economics Association International Conference; Yonsei University at Wonju

2016: Bank of Korea; KDI School of Public Policy and Management; Korea Development Institute; Korea Economic Research Institute; Korea University; Seoul National University; University of Hawaii Asian Studies Graduate Student Conference; Western Economics Association International Conference

2013-2015: Brown University, Department of Economics, Macroeconomics Seminar; Macroeconomics Lunch Seminar; Urban Lunch Seminar

Grants

2026-2030: National Research Foundation of Korea Social Science Korea (SSK) Research Grant, Global Agenda Track, "Institutional Design for an Inclusive Energy Transition: An International Comparison of Renewable Energy Expansion and Long-Run Regional Development Outcomes" (Principal Investigator; international co-investigators Solomon Hsiang, Stanford University, Michael Anderson and Marco Gonzalez-Navarro, UC Berkeley)

2024-2027: National Research Foundation of Korea Research Grant "Household debt and risk-taking: Analysis using Korean big data" (with Costas Arkolakis, Yale University and Spencer Kwon, Brown University)

2023-2025: NRF-JSPS International Cooperation Grant (with Junichi Yamasaki, Kobe University and Ken Miura, Kyoto University)

2022-2023: Sogang University's Joint Graduate Student Seminar Grants for 3 Universities (Sogang, Ewha, and Yonsei). Co-organizers: Hee-Seung Yang (Yonsei) and Jongkwan Lee (Ewha)

2022: AI Data Voucher Grant by Korea Data Agency (Social Issue Track)

2022-2023: International Collaborator for the MIT International Science and Technology Initiatives Global Seed Funds, "Leveraging US Damage Data to Estimate AI Based Hurricane Damage" (PI: Siqi Zheng, MIT)

2022-2024: National IT Industry Promotion Agency Sponsorship for GPU Servers for Machine Learning Projects

2022-2023: Co-investigator for UK and South Korea Social Science, Arts and Humanities Connections Grant by the Economic and Social Research Council, United Kingdom, "Deciphering the Miracle on the Han: Lessons for the World on How South Korea Escaped Poverty and Transformed its Economy" (PI: Robin Burgess, LSE)

2022-2023: Co-investigator for Structural Transformation and Economic Growth (STEG) Small Research Grant by the Foreign, Commonwealth, and Development Office, United Kingdom, "Deciphering the Miracle on the Han: Lessons for the World on How South Korea Escaped Poverty and Transformed its Economy" (PI: Robin Burgess, LSE)

2022-2023: European Space Agency's Network of Resources Sponsorship for Access to High-Resolution Satellite Datasets "Predicting Poverty Using Satellite Images and Machine Learning"

2021-2024: National Research Foundation of Korea Research Grant #2021013631 "Multidisciplinary Study of Korean Economic History Using Machine Learning: Case of 1940-50 Korean Land Reform"

2021-2024: National Research Foundation of Korea Research Grant #2021069641 "Predicting Regional Income and Wealth Inequality of South Korea for the Last 100 years Using Geospatial Data and Machine Learning"

2021-2023: Nam Duck Woo Economic Research Institute Long-term Research Grant

2020-2023: Sogang University New Faculty Research Fund

2018-2019: KDI School Research Grant for Empirical Research in Korean Economic Development History

2018-2019: Incheon National University Long-term Research Fund

2017-2018: KDI School Research Grant for Empirical Research in Korean Economic Development History (with Taejong Kim and Sunjin Kim)

2017-2018: Incheon National University New Faculty Research Fund

Fellowships and Awards

2026: Teaching Excellence Award, Graduate School of Economics, Sogang University

2024-2025: Pyeongsan Research Fellow

2023: Best Article Prize in the Study of Democracy & Autocracy, the American Political Science Association

2022: Research Excellence Award, Sogang University

2021: Teaching Excellence Award for Large Lecture Classes, College of Economics, Sogang University

2020: Korean Economy Academic Research Award, the Korean Economic Association

2020: Academic Research Award, Incheon National University

2016: Best Paper Award in Korean Studies, University of Hawaii at Manoa, School of Pacific and Asian Studies, Graduate Student Conference

2015-2016: Brown University Dissertation Completion Proposal Award

2010-2011: Brown University Economics Department Doctoral Fellowship